

Video transcript

Interview Dos and Don'ts

An interview day can be stressful, but if you plan ahead, you can set yourself up for success. So what are the interview dos and don'ts to ensure you're prepared and ready to impress from the moment you arrive.

Let's start with the things you should do. First, ensure you dress appropriately for the opportunity. This might mean wearing formal business attire or business casuals, depending on the company. If you're unsure, it's always better to be slightly overdressed than under dressed.

Second plan your route to the interview location. Make sure you know exactly where to go and how long it will take to get there. Plan to arrive at least 10 to 15 minutes early. This shows punctuality and gives you a buffer in case of any delays.

Third, make sure you carry a few extra copies of your resume, your portfolio, if you have and need one, and any other documents the interviewer might need. It's better to have these with you than to be caught unprepared.

Fourth, act professionally from the moment you walk in the door. Be polite to everyone you meet, whether it's the recruiter, security or anyone else. You never know who might be providing feedback on you later.

Finally, and most importantly, be sure to send a thank you email within 24 hours of the interview. This shows that you're respectful, organized and interested in the position. A brief message thanking the interviewer for their time and reiterating your interest in the role can have a big impact on how the interviewer thinks about you.

Now let's consider things to avoid. First, don't bring unnecessary items to the venue. If you traveled and have large bags, leave them in a hotel or rental car, bringing too many items with you can make you appear unorganized.

Second, avoid speaking negatively about previous employers or work experiences. While it's important to be honest in your interview, focusing on the negative can make you come across as a person who complains. If you're talking negatively about another company, your potential employer may think you'll talk negatively about them, too.

Third, avoid eating or drinking unless offered by the interviewer. Specifically, don't bring your own food or drinks into the interview. You may need water or something to drink during your interview to keep your throat from drying. Request that from the interviewer if they don't offer. Refrain from chewing gum during the interview. This can make you look unprofessional.

Fourth, don't use your phone once you enter the location where you're interviewing. Put your phone on silent and tuck it away. It's tempting to check emails or messages while you wait, but it can make you appear distracted. Put your phone on silent and tuck it away.

By following the dos and avoiding the don'ts, you can set yourself up for a strong interview day. Remember, preparation and professionalism are key. Stay focused, remain calm, and give yourself the best chance to shine.